

Nov 2015 : Sport
Answer Scheme (Examiners' Comments in italics)

From Passage 1

- 1) Give two differences between play and sport that the author suggests in lines 1-3.
Use your own words as far as possible. [2]

From the Text	Suggested Paraphrase
Spontaneous/ unconstrained by time and location (line 1-2) codified (line 2) / agreed duration and designated setting (line 3)	While play is not restricted to when/ how long it can take place, sport has a specified length of play/timespan. [1] Play can take place anywhere/not restricted to where it be situated, sport needs a specified location for it to be carried out [1] <i>Direct contrast between play and sport must be presented for each of the 2 differences.</i>

- 2) Explain how the development of women's sport can be hindered by the actions of television schedulers and sponsors (lines 30-31). **Use your own words as far as possible.** [2]

From the Text	Explanation
Television schedulers often marginalise it (line 30) Sponsors discriminating against women in the rewards they offer (line 31)	Television schedulers de-prioritise women's sport <u>leading to a lack of exposure for the sportswomen and their events</u> [1] Sponsors are unfair in giving women less in terms of the prizes or awards that are given to their male counterparts and this <u>does not incentivise women to take part</u> OR <u>this lowers the status/prestige of women's sport</u> <i>Question is not simply asking for the actions of television schedulers and sponsors to be paraphrased <u>but required an explanation of how the consequences of these actions might</u></i>

hinder the development of women's sport.

- 3) In paragraph 5, the author describes the difficulties sportswomen face as “cultural” and “practical”. Give one **example** of **each** difficulty that the author provides and explain how it would hinder a sportswoman's career. [2]

From the Text	Possible Explanation
Cultural difficulties faced: expectation that they observe a code of modesty ...live a life of domesticity ...media present thinness as preferable to muscle (lines 35 -36)	Sportswomen are not supposed to seek glory for themselves and this is an obstacle in their pursuit in sporting achievement OR Sportswomen are supposed to cover their bodies and not wear revealing sportswear and this limits the type of sport they can take part in. Sportswomen have to devote themselves to their families even as they try to pursue sport which makes the juggling of these roles challenging. The media expects sportswomen to be slim and not have bulky physique which discourages them from certain sports [Any one of the above – 1 mark]
Practical difficulties: less leisure time than men... eight times more likely to suffer stress fractures (lines 37-38)	Sportswomen do not have as much free time to train compared to sportsmen. <i>Sportswomen are far more susceptible to bone injuries compared to their male counterparts.</i> [Any one of the above – 1 mark] <i>The key word was “sportswomen” and better candidates did focus on the</i>

	<i>difficulties these women faced in their chosen career...not women in general and how they did not even begin a career in sport because of the obstacles they face.</i>
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4) What is the author suggesting by writing “such advances may seep rather than cascade down” (line 42)? [1]

From the Text	Inference
	He is implying the difference is in the <u>rate</u> of change: he thinks that the improvements in technology that will spread from sports cars to the usual cars people drive are more likely to be slow/gradual than rapid.

5) Using material from paragraphs 2-4 only, summarise what the author has to say about the benefits sport brings both to the individual and to society.
Write your summary in no more than 120 words, not counting the opening words which are printed below. **Use your own words as far as possible.** [8]

Firstly, playing sport benefits us...

	From the passage	Possible paraphrase
a	improves our coordination, balance and flexibility	enhances our psychomotor skills/ physical movements
b	combating obesity	fighting weight gain
c	develops important character traits	builds our character in terms of significant values we need
d	our self-esteem is increased	boosts our self-confidence/morale
e	when we rise to the challenges and achieve goals	when we strive and succeed
f	offers us a retreat – from stresses of modern living	allows us to take a break from the pressures of living in contemporary

		society
g	social interaction it entails provides an antidote to isolation	meeting people through sport fights /counters loneliness
h	in team sport we work together towards a common goal	we collaborate in team sport to achieve shared aspirations/targets
i	can acquire leadership skills/ responsibility towards others	learn to take charge/be at the helm and be accountable towards team-mates
j	(competitive sport) develops modesty in victory	fosters sense of humility when one wins
k	resilience in defeat	the ability to bounce back/not give up when one loses
l	learn to lose at something relatively trivial	learn to accept defeat in comparatively insignificant events such as sport
m	To prepare ourselves for setbacks in life which really matter	Makes us ready to deal with disappointments/failure in significant life events
n	staging the highest level of international competition brings prestige	Hosting global sporting events brings status/recognition/honour
o	and is lucrative	and generates wealth/promotes economic growth for the host countries
p	offers benign outlet for patriotic passions	Provides a harmless/non-aggressive means to show love for one's country
q	provides platform for displays of national solidarity in the face of disasters	and gives an avenue for demonstrating unity during crises
r	provides us with an aesthetic pleasure	Spectators find beauty and enjoyment in watching sports performance
s	the very best performers ...set new benchmarks for succeeding generations to improve upon	Champions set new records for young blood/aspiring future champions to surpass
t	exhibit highest standards of behavior in victory and defeat	display the best in their conduct regardless of winning or losing

1-2pts: 1m, 3-4pts:2m, 5-6pts:3m, 7-8pts:4m, 9-10pts:5m, 11-12pts: 6m, 13 pts: 7m, 14pts and above: 8m
From Passage 2

6) What is the author implying about reaction to the survey by the use of the word “resignation” in line 7 [1]

From the Text	Suggested explanation and paraphrase
	The reaction of the authorities to the survey implied that expected such a response from sportspeople and they felt that nothing could be done about it. <i>(No mark awarded if the answer is about the author’s reaction instead of the sporting community.)</i>

7) In paragraph 2, how does the author support his idea that the Faust myth “does not seem outdated” (line 14)? **Use your own words as far as possible.** [2]

From the Text	Possible Explanation
Centuries-old Faust myth...pact with the devil: in return for a set period of uninterrupted success...give up his soul (lines 11-13) Athletes in survey ...would take an imaginary drug guaranteeing victory ...for five years...knowing they would die from its side effects (lines 9-11)	In the Faust myth, a person is willing to pay a very high/the ultimate price for short term assured fulfilment of his desired achievements. [1] This myth does not seem outdated as parallels can be drawn with athletes who are prepared to take drugs in order to be assured of winning but at the cost of their health and lives later on. [1]

8) Why has the author written “performance-enhancing substances” in inverted commas (line 17)? [1]

From the Text	Possible Explanation
	The author wants to show that this phrase is a euphemism/nicer-sounding term <u>that does not show what it really is – an act of dishonesty/cheating to gain an unfair edge over other competitors.</u>

9) What distinction is the author making when he refers to “confessions and revelations of drug taking (lines 19-20)? **Use your own words as far as possible.** [2]

From the Text	Suggested Paraphrase/Explanation
	The difference is that in “confessions”, the guilty athletes voluntarily admit to the doping while in “revelations”, the act of doping is made known as a result of exposure by someone else/a whistleblower

- 10) In paragraph 4, what differences does the author see between successful athletes in the nineteenth century and those of today? **Use your own words as far as possible.** [2]

From the Text	Possible Explanation
In the nineteenth century... naturally talented individuals, the amateurs who performed for the sheer fun of it and whose victories seemed effortless (lines 25-26) ... genuine talent (lines 30-31) Today’s professional champions ... festooned with sponsors’ logos, punishing training regimes, supported by teams of nutritionists, sports scientists and psychologists (lines 27 - 28) ... chemical enhancement...financial skullduggery (line 31)	In the nineteenth century, athletes were innately gifted sportspeople who could win without much help or hard work whereas today, sportspeople need much financial assistance from sponsors and support experts from various fields in order to win. [1] The athletes in the past pursued sports for intrinsic pleasure/solely for enjoyment but today, sportspeople are motivated to win by the sponsorship deals and even resort to doping or shady financial dealings in order to win. [1]

- 11) In the final sentence of paragraph 5, what contrast does the author make between what sport should be and what it often is? Use your own words as far as possible. [2]

From the Text	Possible Explanation
...featuring the best of human athletic endeavours encourages much that is worst in human nature	Sport should demonstrate/allow sportspeople to display the highest ideals/loftiest values in their sporting efforts [1] but today, it is prompting people to show the lowest/most vile characteristics in mankind. [1]

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The Application Question

One writer thinks sport has considerable value, while the other questions this view. How important is sport to you and your society, and how far do you agree or disagree with the opinions expressed in these two passages? [10]

Requirements of this Question:

1. Must make a stand addressing the question ‘How **important** is sport...?’
2. Apply to given context – ‘**you and your society**’
3. Make reference to the **key ideas/main points** in **both** passages showing clearly which key ideas/main points you agree or disagree with

Key Ideas from Robb

Sport is important as it is beneficial to the sportsperson in numerous ways: it improves our physical well-being in areas like our coordination, balance and flexibility; builds character; increases our self-esteem; offers an outlet for stress; helps us to learn how to cooperate with others and develops leadership skills; teaches resilience and modesty in the face of failure and success respectively. For the spectators, watching sport provides much pleasure comparable to the sense of aesthetic enjoyment one derives from the Arts; provides a platform for the display of patriotism; unites people in times of crisis. Finally, for country and the economy, sport can promote technological innovations and hosting international sporting competitions brings prestige to the host nation and economic benefits.

Key Ideas from Benjamin

Today, for the athletes and sporting community, sport has been tainted by drug-taking and financial scandals like bribery and match-fixing; there is an ethical void in the way sport is played where winning is everything. Professional sportspeople play for money (not for just pure joy) and bad behavior is celebrated whilst virtues like compassion and magnanimity are seen as weaknesses. For sports fans, sport is a distraction from

pressing issues of the day, where media coverage on sport pushes aside more important matters.

Many pointed out how the fast-paced life in Singapore made the pursuit of a sporting interest very difficult to fit in, whilst recognizing it as an important source of relaxation. Given Singapore's small size, many said it was not surprising that there were few local heroes (though the exploits of some were celebrated). There was considerable debate on the topic of athletes who were not born in Singapore representing the country in the Olympic Games, for example.

Candidates demonstrated a great deal of interest in sporting events around the world. The one home event that was most discussed was the F1 Grand Prix, and this had its supporters and detractors, as did the Youth Olympics. Opinions were divided as to whether the cost of staging these events was justified.

On the subject of drug-taking, almost all thought this is not an issue in Singapore, given the stringent controls in place and the severe penalties that could be incurred. There was also much debate about the aspect of corruption in sport, including match-fixing.

Strong answers moved beyond description of what has happened and what is being done, to insightful and energetic analysis of the purposes and intentions of policies and their short and long term impacts, mediated through the candidates' own experiences. The well-informed personal voice led to more varied and interesting responses than those where the candidates chose to assess which was the more persuasive piece of the writing without focusing on their own lives or the wider social context.